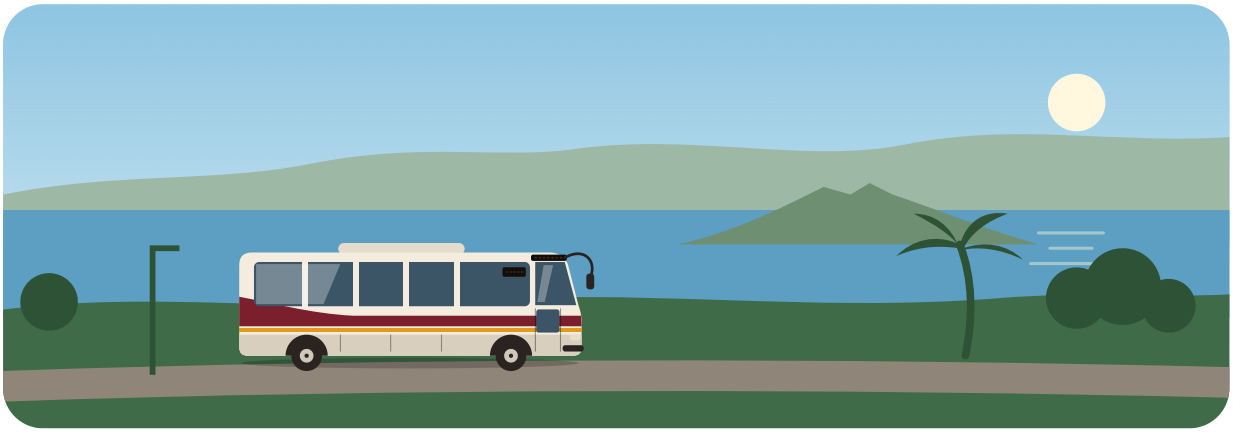
MENDEZ / TAGAYTAY
⇄ ONE AYALA

COMMUNITY LIVE TRACKER · UNOFFICIAL · BRIEFING FOR THE OPERATOR



A community-run live bus tracker for your route

What it is, exactly what it records, what it structurally cannot do, and what we are asking of you.

PREPARED BY THE VOLUNTEER WHO MAINTAINS IT

This tool is not affiliated with, operated by, or endorsed by Wonderful Transport. It was built by a commuter, it runs on a personal account, and it says all of this on its own front page and inside its privacy panel. The route name is used only so riders can tell which buses it tracks. Nothing in this document claims otherwise, and nothing in the tool does either.

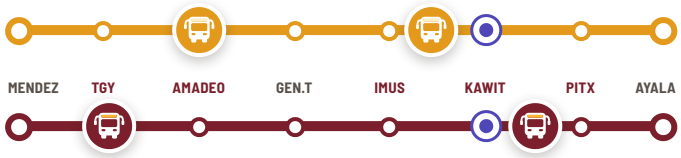
1 · WHAT IT IS

Commuters on this corridor currently find out where the bus is by asking in a Messenger group chat. This is the same question answered on a map. Anyone on board — a rider, a conductor, a driver — can tap a button to put their bus's position on a shared map for the length of that one trip. Everyone else can open a link and see it. There is no app to install and no account to create.

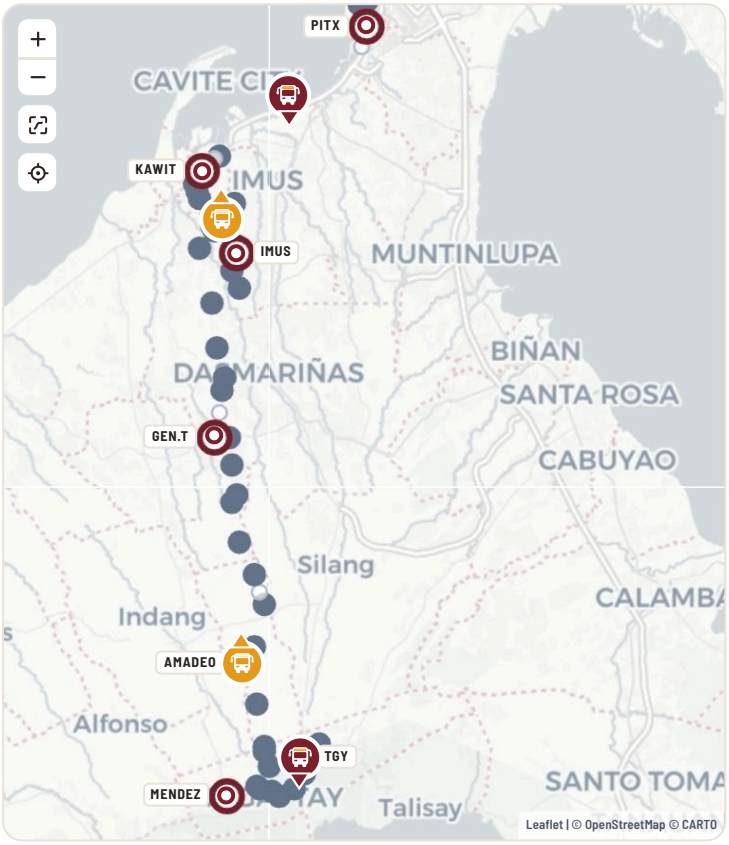
It covers one route: Mendez / Tagaytay to One Ayala, in both directions, using the checkpoints and stops from your own posted material.

What a rider sees when four buses are sharing. Example screen.

NORTHBOUND → ONE AYALA

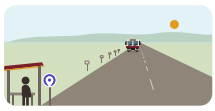


← SOUTHBOUND · TO MENDEZ



S&R KAWIT

Change



about **5** stops before yours · 3.0 km

▲ Northbound · bus 98018 · next stop **Battle of Alapan Monument** · updated 8s ago

4 BUSES LIVE

All buses | ▲ Northbound | ▼ Southbound

▲ 98018 3 km to KAWIT 8s ago

▲ 98104 AMADEO 47s ago

▼ TGY 2m ago · 2 sharing

▼ 98077 7 km to KAWIT 1m ago

2 · WHAT IT RECORDS, AND WHAT IT CANNOT DO

This is the section we would want to read first in your position, so it comes before anything we are asking for.

There is no location history. Anywhere.

The database holds **one row per bus that is sharing right now**. Each position update **overwrites** the previous one. There is no trail table, no archive, and no backup of one — the schema has nowhere to put it. When the person on board taps Stop or closes the page, the row is deleted and the bus disappears from every map.

The consequence, stated plainly: **this tool cannot be used to review any driver's speed, breaks, route deviation, or working hours** — not because we promise not to, but because the data required to do it is never written down. Nobody can produce it later: not us, not you, and not anyone who compels us. It does not exist, not even on a sharer's own phone (below).

WHAT IS STORED	FOR HOW LONG	WHAT IT IS NOT
Current position of a bus that is actively sharing: coordinates, direction, the bus number if one was typed, and a random session ID.	Overwritten every few seconds. Deleted on Stop, on closing the page, or automatically once it goes stale.	No name, no phone number, no account, nothing identifying the person. No previous position is retained. If its sharer chose to, it carries a drawing of their bus (below).
Count of devices currently watching the map.	A random per-tab ID, deleted three minutes after the tab closes.	A live gauge, not a log. No daily totals, no peaks, no history of who watched or when.
Thanks for a bus that is sharing right now: how many riders tapped Salamat on it, as a scrambled value per tap.	Deleted the instant that trip ends — on Stop, on closing the page, or once the bus goes stale. It is stored as a child of the position row, so it cannot outlive it.	Not a rating, not a score, and never a total. Nothing adds up across trips, so no figure for any driver exists to be produced. Only the person sharing that bus can see the number; riders cannot see it on anyone's bus, including their own.
Text sightings — "northbound at Amadeo" — for when nobody is sharing GPS.	Deleted automatically after a couple of hours.	Posted with no name attached.
Route settings: operating hours, headway, a pinned notice.	Until an organiser changes them.	Not personal data of any kind.

Two things can be kept, and only on the sharer's own phone

At the end of a trip the person sharing is shown a ticket for it. If they tap Keep, a souvenir copy stays on their phone until they delete it: the day, the direction, the two places they got on and off, and a stamp or two such as "before 5 AM". It is built with **no times, no trip length, no bus number and no thank-you count**, so even a phone full of them cannot time a trip, show a break or rank anyone. The app never sends it to us or to anyone else; a sharer may send a picture of a ticket themselves, which shows those same things and nothing more. The phone also keeps a few totals, to decorate a drawing of a bus in the app: how many trips, how many were early, late or end to end, the time on the map and the thank-yous in all, how many weeks in a row it has shared, and the app's own points for decorating it, drawn as spare parts, which cannot be bought with money and are earned on three trips a day at most. **Totals, not a log**: beside them it remembers only the week of its last trip and the day of its last earning one, each overwritten by the next. They say how much a phone has shared, never a list of days or any time of day, so they show no shift and no break. A sharer can save all of it to a file of their own as a backup; the app never sends it anywhere.

A sharer may show riders a drawing of their bus

The app lets a sharer decorate a drawing of a bus: things earned by sharing, and paint and accessories got with the app's own points. It stays on their phone unless they switch on **Show customized bus to riders**, which is off until they do. Then each position they send carries a short code for the drawing, letters from the app's own fixed lists that cannot spell a word or carry a colour of anyone's choosing, and a rider who taps that bus sees it. It is deleted with the position. The honest cost, which the app states beside the switch: **riders can recognise a decorated bus from one trip to the next**. That is why it is the sharer's choice.

The direction check never leaves the phone

The app warns someone who picked the wrong direction by tracking how far along the route their bus has travelled. That calculation happens **in the sharing phone's own memory**, is never transmitted or stored, and is discarded when the tab closes. It exists to stop commuters being told a bus is coming when it is going away.

Sharing is voluntary, per trip, and stops on its own

Nobody is tracked without acting. A person taps a button, picks a direction, and can stop at any moment. The app also stops by itself: it asks "still on the bus?" after twenty minutes without movement, and ends the session on its own once the bus has been parked at its destination. Closing the browser tab ends it too.

The live map is public, so it can be watched

That is the point of it, but it has a consequence worth stating here rather than having it discovered: while a bus is being shared, anyone watching the map could write down where it is, as they could from the roadside. That record would be theirs, made as it happened. **This system keeps none**, and stores no speed at all.

3 · WHO CAN DO WHAT

Three separate credentials, deliberately not interchangeable. All reads and writes go through server-side functions; the underlying tables are not directly reachable.

CREDENTIAL	WHO HOLDS IT	WHAT IT ALLOWS
Route name public	Anyone	Watching the map. Open to everybody, no key needed.
Sharing key secret	Posted in the community group chat	Putting a bus on the map. Can be a long key or a short PIN; repeated wrong PINs pause new trips for a few minutes. Can be rotated at any time, which cuts off everyone using the old one. The organiser can also open sharing to everyone, without the key, and close it again.
Organiser key secret	The volunteer maintainer only	Operating hours, a pinned notice, removing a bad sighting, stopping a particular sharer, rotating the sharing key, and opening or closing sharing to everyone.

If a bus is being shared by someone who should not be, an organiser can stop that session, and rotating the sharing key ends all sharing until the new key is distributed. If sharing has been opened to everyone, closing it again takes every bus started without the key off the map at once. **That switch can be handed to you.**

4 · WHAT WE ARE ASKING

Three things, in order. The first needs nothing from you but a reply.

1 **Tell us if you want it changed or gone.**

This is the whole reason for the letter. If anything here concerns you — the route name, the colours, the fact it exists — say so and we will change it or switch it off. The tool has one maintainer and no commercial interest in continuing against your wishes.

Needed from you: a reply. Nothing else.

2 **Let it be posted where riders will see it, and let crew mention it.**

A tracker nobody knows about helps nobody. Permission to put a flyer at Mendez Crossing, Olivarez Terminal and One Ayala, and for conductors to point at it when asked "anong oras ang susunod?", would do more for it than anything else — and it reduces the number of people asking your staff that question.

Needed from you: permission. No cost, no system to integrate.

3 **Work with us, at whatever depth suits you.**

Options, from smallest to largest — take any, all, or none:

- **Your schedule, kept current.**

  The app shows operating hours and headway. Right now those come from your posted material, which states it may change without notice. Told directly, we would update them the same day and riders would stop relying on a stale poster.

- **Crew sharing during trips.**

  A conductor with a mounted phone produces far better coverage than an occasional volunteer rider. Same button, same limits described above.

- **Take it over entirely.**

  The tool is free and open source under a licence that lets you run your own copy. We will hand over the route, the keys and the setup, and step back — or shut ours down so there is only one.

Needed from you: a conversation.

5 · WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Nothing. There is no invoice attached to any of the options above and there will not be one later. The tool runs on free hosting tiers, is maintained by one volunteer commuter in their own time, carries no advertising, sells nothing, and has no analytics beyond the live count of open tabs described in section 2. The source code is public, so any claim in this document can be checked rather than taken on trust.

6 · WHAT IT DOES NOT DO WELL

Stated here so nobody discovers it later.

- **It is only as good as its volunteers.** When nobody on board is sharing, the map is empty. An empty map does not mean there is no bus, and the app says so.
- **It is not an official schedule** and never claims to be. Positions come from passengers' phones, not from dispatch or vehicle hardware.
- **In a browser, a phone must stay awake to share.** Mobile browsers suspend GPS when the screen locks, so a session ends when someone pockets their phone. A mounted phone on a charger is the practical answer. On Android there is now an app that keeps sharing with the screen locked, with a notification showing the whole time; on an iPhone, the screen still has to stay on.
- **It cannot tell your bus from another vehicle** travelling the same road. The bus number field, typed by the sharer, is the only thing that distinguishes them.
- **The direction is picked by hand** and can be picked wrongly. The check described in section 2 catches it after a few kilometres, pauses that bus, and asks the person to confirm.

TO REPLY, OR TO ASK US TO STOP

One person maintains this and reads everything sent to it.

johnvincentland@gmail.com

Source code: github.com/jvlandingin/community-bus-tracker

The tracker itself: community-bus-tracker.netlify.app

This tool is not affiliated with, run by, or endorsed by Wonderful Transport. Positions come from passengers and crew who choose to share, so it is not an official schedule and the company is not responsible for it. It is provided as-is, with no warranty of accuracy or uptime. The route name and colours are used so riders can tell which buses it tracks, and for no other purpose.